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Skechers is making kids' shoes with a hidden AirTag compartment



Amanda Silberling — 8:13 AM PDT · July 30, 2025

Skechers introduced a line of kids' sneakers that contain a hidden compartment where parents can slip in an Apple AirTag.

Inside the heel of the shoe, a small insert can be lifted to reveal the compartment. Then, parents can track the location of their child — or, at least their child's shoes. These shoes don't come with an AirTag, and they don't appear to be an actual collaboration with Apple, but rather a third-party product that Skechers has developed on its own.

The shoes were announced in mid-July to little press, but [AppleInsider](#) reported on the product on Wednesday.

IMAGE CREDITS: SKECHERS

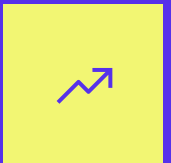
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Apple only advertises its AirTags as products to keep track of items like keys, wallets, or luggage —

not human beings. But parents have been using the technology to keep an eye on their kids. Already, there are products like AirTag-compatible bracelets, insoles, pins, or even knock-off Crocs Jibbitz that can fit an AirTag.

Perhaps intentionally, AirTags are not designed to be very good at tracking fast-moving things, like a kid on a school bus, for example. Unlike an iPhone with location sharing enabled, AirTags don't have built-in GPS. Instead, they use [Bluetooth beaconing technology](#) to quietly signal their presence to nearby Apple devices, giving the owner of the AirTag an estimate of its location.

This technology can still be used for nefarious purposes, however. Bad actors have hidden AirTags in people's bags or cars to stalk them, which sparked [a class action lawsuit](#). Apple has [instituted](#) some anti-stalking features, such as notifying someone via their iPhone or Apple Watch when an unfamiliar AirTag is traveling with them.

Since Skechers only makes this product in kids' sizes, it's unlikely that these shoes could be used to surveil adults against their will — but the continued normalization of this kind of surveillance could have implications beyond childcare. It's possible that Skechers or another shoe brand could make similar products designed for adults with conditions like dementia, who may unintentionally wander away from their caretakers. While those uses may be well-intentioned, these kinds of products could also be used to track adults without their consent.

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Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She...

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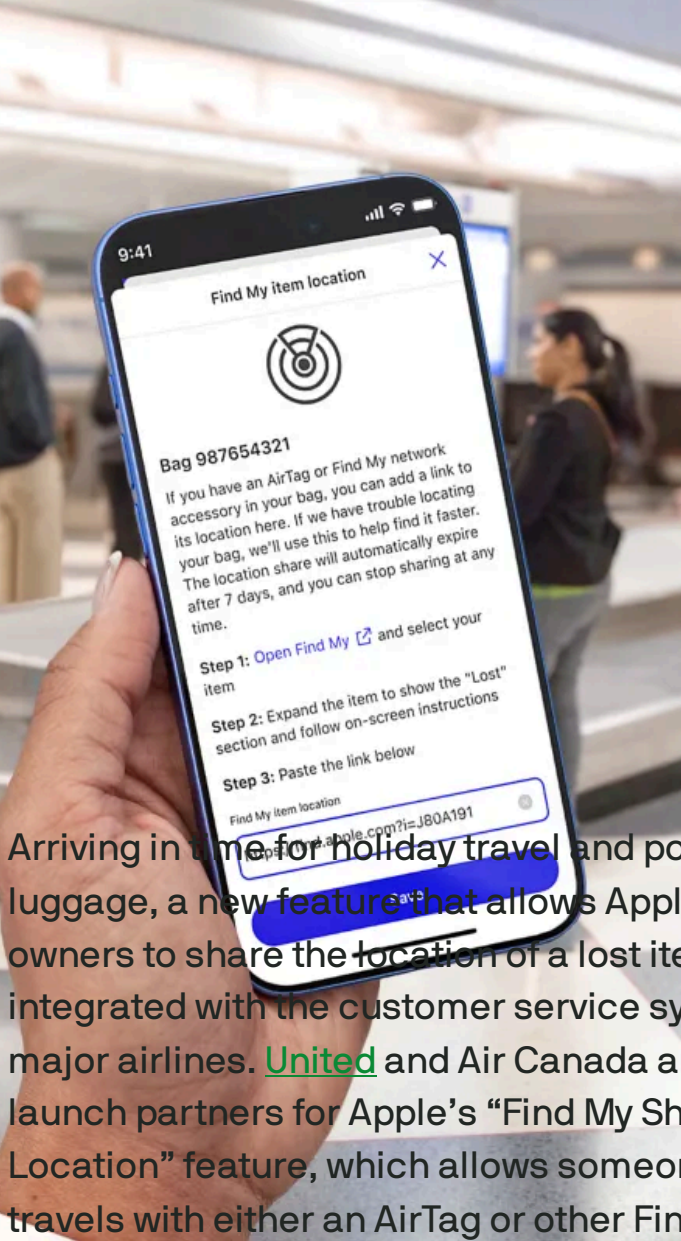
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United and Air Canada can now use Apple AirTags to track lost luggage

Sarah Perez — 7:17 AM PST · December 12, 2024



Arriving in time for holiday travel and potentially lost luggage, a new feature that allows Apple AirTag owners to share the location of a lost item is now integrated with the customer service systems of two major airlines. [United](#) and Air Canada are the first launch partners for Apple's "Find My Share Item Location" feature, which allows someone who travels with either an AirTag or other Find My network-connected accessory to use Apple's Find My app to share the location of their lost item with the airline's customer service system to speed up the process of locating lost or delayed luggage.

The feature, now available with Apple's iOS 18.2 operating system for iPhone, iPadOS 18.2 for iPad, and macOS 15.2 on Mac, lets customers generate a Share Item Location link from within the Find My app. The customer can then share that link with the customer service personnel tasked with helping locate the missing bags.

The addition capitalizes on one of AirTags' more popular use cases. Consumers were already using the small tracking devices to see where their luggage was when traveling. In one recent case, the AirTag showed that a lost bag was inside the airport, but United told the customer it was not — [even](#)

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[saying to them that their system didn't go by AirTags](#). The customer's luggage ended up then traveling 30 miles away, leading the customer to believe the employee stole the bag. Now, those types of incidents should be less common, as United will, in fact, officially use AirTag locations as part of its customer service efforts.

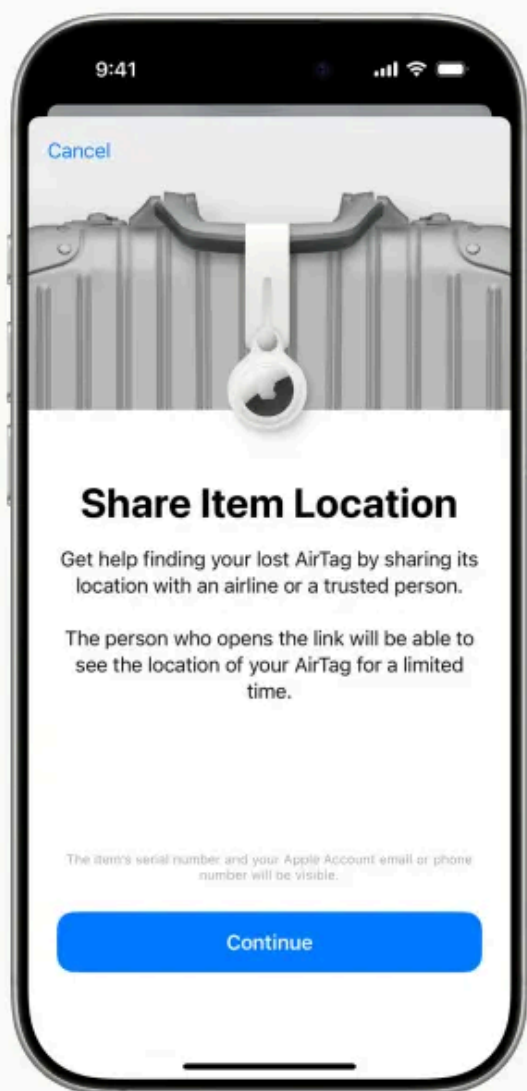


IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

Apple says the links generated are secure and private, and the location-sharing aspect will automatically end when the customer is reunited with their lost bag. Location-sharing can also be stopped by the customer at any time. In addition, the link will expire after seven days, giving the airline plenty of time to locate and return the luggage. The process is also end-to-end encrypted so no one

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else, including accessory manufacturers, will have access to the device's location or other personal information.

Many airlines already offer systems for tracking luggage in their apps, making AirTags more of a supplement to their existing systems. The AirTag location, however, could be used when the airline's luggage tracking system has it wrong.

While United and Air Canada are the first to support the feature, Apple says other airline partners are on the way.

Previously, the iPhone maker said it had nearly 20 airlines queued up to integrate with its system, including Aer Lingus, Air New Zealand, Austrian Airlines, British Airways, Brussels Airlines, Delta Air Lines, Eurowings, Iberia, KLM Royal Dutch Airlines, Lufthansa, Qantas, Singapore Airlines, Swiss International Air Lines, Turkish Airlines, Virgin Atlantic, and Vueling.



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Dec. 13: After the publication of this article, Delta joined United and Air Canada in supporting the feature.

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Consumer News Editor |

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

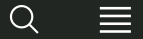
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Apple's updated Personal Safety User Guide addresses the AirTag stalking problem

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do if they find an AirTag or other Find My network accessory following them. It even contains instructions for Android users, too.

The addition to the guide was first spotted by the sites [9to5Mac](#) and [AppleInsider](#). Apple confirmed to TechCrunch the guide was updated today with the AirTag-related information.

IMAGE CREDITS:

JAMES D. MORGAN / CONTRIBUTOR / GETTY

IMAGES
However, the guide itself isn't new. The same manual had [previously offered](#) information designed to help people who were worried their personal safety was at risk or who were concerned about other ways they could be stalked or tracked via Apple devices. In general, it focused on helping people who had previously shared information with a partner, and who now wanted to ensure that person no longer could access their account, their data or their location, among other things.

In the case of AirTag, though, it's not always a partner abuse situation leading to the stalking. A report by [The New York Times](#), for example, highlighted how car thieves were using AirTag devices to track and locate high-end vehicles they planned to steal. Others said they were getting



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alerts about being tracked by an AirTag after they left a public place, like their local gym. Some parents were also using the devices to track their teenage children without informing them, the story noted.

As Apple is the first major tech company in the lost-item tracker space to have implemented proactive alerts about unknown Bluetooth trackers nearby, it's brought the stalking situation to light. As The NYT noted, some researchers believe Apple's AirTag didn't necessarily create the tech-enabled stalking problem itself. Instead, it's possible that the AirTag's built-in alerts system has actually revealed what was already a widespread problem. Unfortunately for Apple, this situation has become [a PR liability](#) given how heavily the company has marketed itself as being focused on user safety and privacy.

While various Apple spokespersons have provided statements to reporters covering AirTag stalking cases, the new guide now serves as a more official form of documentation on the matter.

It explains to users what it means when they receive an alert, why they might hear an AirTag make a sound and how to use the [new Tracker Detect app for Android](#). Most importantly, it points to the [Apple support documentation](#) about what to do if you find an unknown AirTag following you, and how to make it play a sound if you can't otherwise find it.

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With the documentation update, the guide has now been published as a searchable website instead of just a PDF. This allows Google and other search engines to better index its contents in order to point web users to the right page based on their search query. It may also be easier to keep the guide updated as new personal safety documentation and guidance becomes available.

Beyond the AirTag information, the refreshed guide also now includes information on newer Apple features that weren't available when it was first published — like Apple's App Privacy Report or information on how to set up recovery contacts. Other new sections cover Home Kit and the Home App, private browsing mode, how to block people through messages, phone, FaceTime and email, how to take a screenshot to document suspicious activity, and how to set up account recovery contacts.

[Apple AirTags UX teardown: The trade-off between privacy and user experience](#)

Combined with the existing information on managing account security and privacy, the new guide makes for a more comprehensive document than the earlier version.

However, the issue with AirTag, specifically, was not really about the lack of documentation or consumer confusion over what to do, but the fact that AirTags themselves are simply too easy to use for stalking

purposes. In addition to being affordable devices, their ring isn't loud enough to notice, at times — especially if the AirTag has been placed somewhere like on the underside of a car or behind a license plate. And the alerts about unknown AirTags are too infrequent, privacy advocates have argued.

Apple has yet to address these and other complaints by changing AirTag's functionality, but the guide's publication indicates the company is at least well aware of the problem and looking to provide some sort of resource to consumers.

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Chipolo's newest AirTag competitor works with both Apple and Google's finding networks

Sarah Perez — 8:08 AM PDT · April 14, 2025

[Chipolo](#), the maker of AirTag-like devices, on Monday introduced the latest version of its product. Now, instead of offering models that only work with either Apple or Google's lost-item finding technology, the new Chipolo POP devices work with both companies' finding networks out of the box.

By combining these different functionalities into one device, Chipolo believes it will be easier for consumers to choose the right device for their needs. Plus, this would make Chipolo products better for gifting because buyers won't need to know whether the recipient uses Android or an iPhone, the company said.

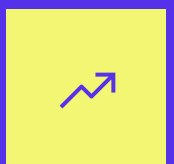
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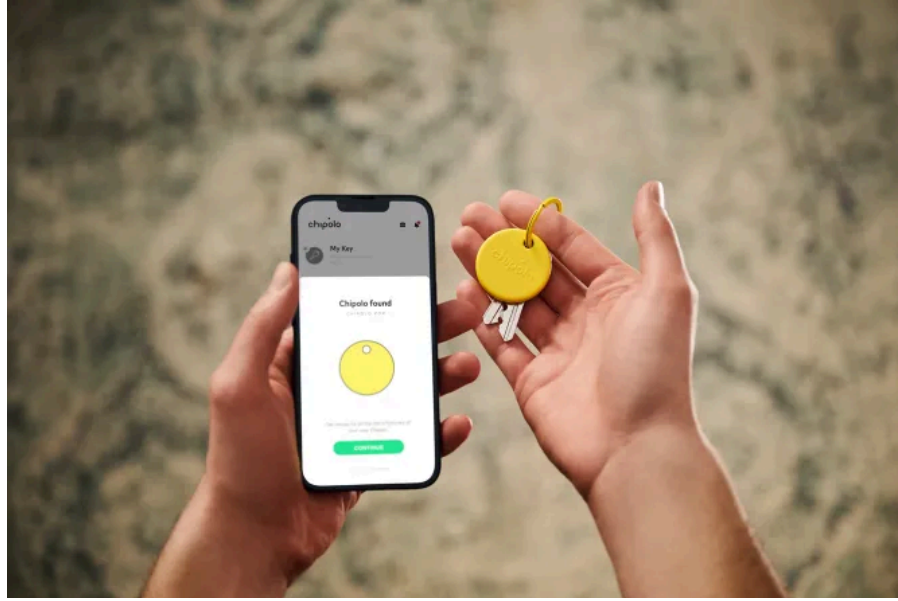
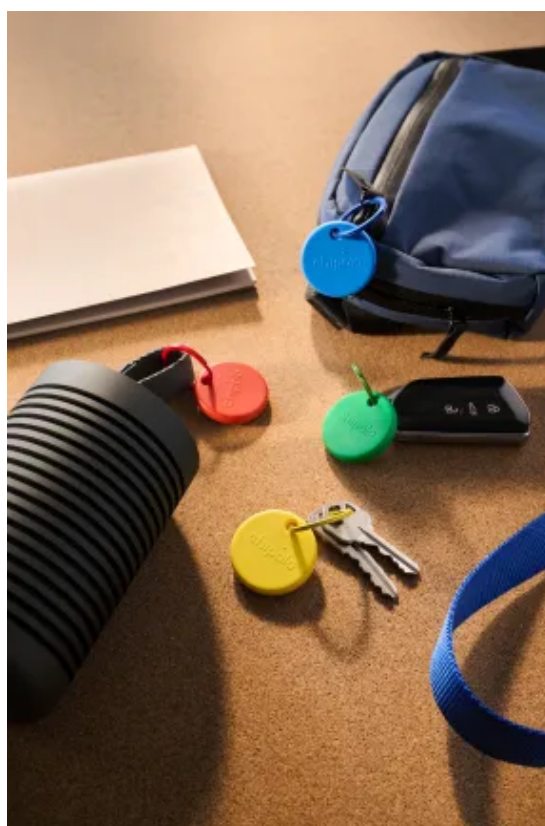


IMAGE CREDITS:CHIPOLO

The Chipolo devices are among a handful of companies, including Tile, Pebblebee, and Samsung, that make their own AirTag-like trackers.

Unlike Tile, which designed a finding network that leveraged the people who had its mobile app installed, Chipolo chose to work with the existing finding networks offered by platform makers Apple and Google. (Though Tile arrived before the AirTag, the competition from Apple ultimately led to its finding an exit by selling in 2021 to family locator service Life360 for [\\$205 million](#).)

To date, Chipolo has sold more than 4.5 million of its devices. Following the launch of its first “Find My” compatible product, the Chipolo ONE Spot and the Chipolo Card Spot, it’s seen a 30% average in annual growth, the company



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IMAGE CREDITS:CHIPOLO

TechCrunch via email.

In addition to offering support for both Apple and Google’s finding networks, the new Chipolo POP includes other popular features from prior trackers, including the option to find your missing phone by double-pressing on your trackers out-of-range alerts, the ability to change the Chipolo’s ringtone, and the option to use the tracker as a remote selfie shutter.

The Bluetooth range of the device has also been extended to 300 feet (90 meters) and the battery lasts up to one year and is user-replaceable.



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The new devices now come in blue, black, green, red, white, and yellow and sell for \$29 (£30/€35) on Chipolo’s website and Amazon.

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